

08

ORDERING OF WORDS AND SENTENCES

Generally, 10 to 15 questions based on ordering of words and sentences are asked in CDS exam. In these questions, the candidate has to rearrange the jumbled words or phrases to make a meaningful sentence or paragraph.



Ordering of words/sentences is a necessary and indispensable part of the CDS examination. The candidates are required to place the jumbled words or sentences in proper sequence.

In some questions, first and the last sentences of a paragraph are given and the candidate is needed to place the middle sentences in a proper sequence. The sentences should form a coherent order in a logical sequence.

However, in simple questions, you have to arrange a number of jumbled up phrases to form a meaningful sentence.

Arranging the Sentence in Correct Order

The correct sequence is formed when all the sentences are organically linked. A sort of cause-effect relationship is also implicit in such exercises because a sentence will follow another only when the former leads to the latter.

Thus, taking into consideration this aspect, sentences can be easily sequenced.

Sound knowledge of language, helping verbs and conjunctions enables a candidate to solve these questions easily.

Tips for Attempting Questions

- Frame the sentences logically to get a meaningful order.
- Rearrangement of sentences should be grammatically correct.
- Use simple and linear approach to frame the sentence to obtain a logical meaning.

Types of Questions

Usually two types of questions are asked in the exam

TYPE 1

Reordering of words to form a meaningful sentence

In this type, the initial part of the sentence is given as a hint. The rest of the sentence is divided into a number of phrases (labelled as P, Q, R, S) and given in a jumbled form.

The candidate has to rearrange the jumbled parts of the sentence to form a meaningful sentence. The initial part of the sentence serves as a hint for arranging the given phrases into a sentence.

Some examples of this type are given below.

Directions (Q. Nos. 1 and 2) *In the questions given below, there is a sentence of which some parts have been jumbled up. Rearrange these parts which are labelled as P, Q, R and S to produce a correct sentence. Choose the **proper sequence** among the alternatives.*

1. P : himself
Q : a child
R : can usually feed
S : by the age of six months

The correct sequence should be

- (a) QPRS (b) SRQP
(c) PQRS (d) QRPS

Explanation (d) *The correct sequence is QRPS i.e.*
A child can usually feed himself by the age of six months.

2. The boy
P : in the competition
Q : who was wearing spectacles
R : won many prizes
S : held in our college

The correct sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) RPSQ
(c) QRPS (d) QPSR

Explanation (c) *The correct sequence is QRPS i.e.* The boy who was wearing spectacles won many prizes in the competition held in our college.

TYPE 2

Reordering of sentences to form a meaningful paragraph

In this type, the initial and final part of the paragraph is given and labelled as S1 and S6. The rest of the paragraph is broken into 4 parts (labelled as P, Q, R, S) and given in a jumbled form.

The candidate needs to arrange the jumbled parts (P, Q, R, S) in a way that the resultant paragraph is coherent and meaningful.

Some examples of this type are given below.

Directions (Q. Nos. 3 and 4) *In the questions given below, each passage consists of six sentences. The first and the sixth sentences are given in the beginning. The middle four sentences in each have been removed and jumbled up. These are labelled as P, Q, R and S. Find out the **proper order** of the four sentences.*

3. S1 : She said on the phone that she would report for duty next day.

S6 : Eventually we reported to the police.

P : We waited for few days then we decided to go to her place.

Q : But she did not.

R : We found it locked.

S : Even after that we waited for her for quite a few days.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PRSQ (b) QPSR (c) QPRS (d) SQPR

Explanation (c) *The correct sequence is QPRS i.e.*

She said on the phone that she would report for duty next day. But she did not. We waited for few days then we decided to go to her place. We found it locked. Even after that we waited for her for quite a few days. Eventually we reported to the police.

4. S1: Throughout history, man has used energy from the Sun.

S6: This energy comes from inside atoms.

P: Today, when we burn wood or use electric current, we are drawing energy.

Q: However, we now have a new supply of energy.

R: All our ordinary life depends on Sun.

S: This has come from the Sun.

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQPR (b) RQPS (c) QSRP (d) PSRQ

Explanation (d) *The correct sequence is PSRQ i.e.*

Throughout history, man has used energy from the Sun. Today, when we burn wood or use electric current, we are drawing energy. This has come from the Sun. All our ordinary life depends on Sun. However, we now have a new supply of energy, this energy comes from inside atoms.

ORDERING OF WORDS AND SENTENCES

COMPLETE EXERCISE

Directions (Q. Nos. 1-55) In the questions given below, there is a sentence of which some parts have been jumbled up. Rearrange these parts which are labelled as P, Q, R and S to produce the correct sentence. Choose the **proper sequence** among the alternatives.

1. Little

P : that he had been let down
Q : stood by all these years
R : did he realise
S : by a colleague whom he had

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RPSQ (b) RSQP
(c) QSRP (d) QSPR

2. There was

P : needed for its everyday life
Q : a time when each family
R : for itself most of the things it
S : actually produced

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRSP (b) RQPS
(c) RSPQ (d) QSRP

3. Then

P : it struck me
Q : of course
R : suitable it was
S : how eminently

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SPQR (b) QSRP
(c) PSRQ (d) QPSR

4. The grocer

P : did not listen to the protests of customer
Q : who was in the habit of weighing less
R : whom he had cheated
S : with great audacity

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PRSQ (b) QSPR
(c) QPRS (d) PQSR

5. Though he dialled frequently

P : on telephone
Q : my brother could not contact me
R : and had left no information
S : as I had gone out of office

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPRS (b) SQRP
(c) QPSR (d) SPQR

6. Education is

P : of the proper sense of responsibilities
Q : the first need
R : in a citizen
S : for the development

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQPR (b) QSRP
(c) QSPR (d) PQRS

7. It was

P : in keeping with my mood
Q : a soft summer evening
R : as I walked sedately
S : in the direction of new house

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRPQ (b) QRPS
(c) QPRS (d) SQPR

8. With her body

P : dragging her unwilling feet
Q : weak and infirm
R : doubled with age
S : she persisted in her mission

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) QPRS
(c) RQPS (d) SRPQ

9. When he

P : did not know
Q : he was nervous and
R : heard the hue and cry at midnight
S : what to do

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RQPS (b) QSPR
(c) SQPR (d) PQRS

10. A French woman

P : committed suicide
Q : where she had put up
R : who had come to Kolkata
S : by jumping from the balcony of the hotel

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PRQS (b) QSRP
(c) RPSQ (d) SRQP

11. I realised that

P : but seeing my host in this mood
Q : I deemed it proper to take leave
R : as I had frequently done before
S : it had been my intention to pass the night there

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPSR (b) QRPS
(c) SPQR (d) SRPQ

12. It was to be

P : before their school examination
Q : which was due to start
R : the last expedition
S : in a month

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRQP (b) RQSP
(c) RPQS (d) SPRQ

13. They felt safer

P : to watch the mountain
Q : of more than five miles
R : as they settled down
S : from a distance

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RPSQ (b) RSQP
(c) PQSR (d) PRSQ

14. If you need help

P : promptly and politely
Q : ask for attendants
R : to help our customers
S : who have instructions

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQPR (b) QPSR
(c) QSRP (d) SQRP

15. He was so kind and generous that

P : he not only
Q : made others do so
R : but also
S : helped them himself

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PSRQ (b) SPQR
(c) PRSQ (d) QPRS

- 16.** Work is the one thing

P : and without it

Q : that is necessary

R : to keep the world going

S : we should all die

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPSR (b) RPQS
(c) SRPQ (d) QRPS

- 17.** I read an advertisement that said

P : posh, air-conditioned

Q : gentleman of taste

R : are available for

S : fully furnished rooms

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PSRQ
(c) PSQR (d) SRPQ

- 18.** It has been established that

P : Einstein was

Q : although a great scientist

R : weak in arithmetic

S : right from his school days

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRPQ (b) QPRS
(c) QPSR (d) RQPS

- 19.** I was

P : and stay for few days in
Delhi

Q : when my father told me

R : very excited

S : that I could go with him

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) RQSP
(c) QRSP (d) SPQR

- 20.** All such students

P : get success

Q : who are honest and
hard-working

R : and recognition

S : in every walk of life

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SPRQ (b) PRQS
(c) QPRS (d) PSRQ

- 21.** Quite a few

P : in the previous years

Q : to large chunks of territory
that India said was its

R : over the Mc Mohan line, with
China laying claims

S : border incursions and clashes
had taken place

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SPRQ (b) PSQR
(c) SPQR (d) PSRQ

- 22.** P : cricketers fail to zero in on
a reason

Q : well against a specific
opposition

R : for their playing
exceptionally

S : past or present

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SPQR (b) PSQR
(c) SPRQ (d) PSRQ

- 23.** P : merely managing chaos and
little or

Q : the deluge in Mumbai
showed that

R : no thought has gone into
upgrading the city

S : successive State
Governments have been

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QSPR (b) PRQS
(c) QRPS (d) PSQR

- 24.** P : giant strides in development

Q : so that we make

R : more and more rational like
Western countries

S : it is high time we become

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQRQ (b) PRQS
(c) SRQP (d) PQRS

- 25.** Compared to

P : was an occasion of stately
pageantry

Q : the birth of the Republic

R : accompanied by partition
riots

S : the dawn of independence

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRPS (b) PRQS
(c) SRQP (d) PQRS

- 26.** P : standing up for their rights

Q : the rebellion may be slow
and sporadic

R : youngsters become the
unlikely heroes

S : but it is happening as

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QSRP (b) PRSQ
(c) PSRQ (d) QRSP

- 27.** P : to sell uranium, nuclear
turbines, fighter planes

Q : to India is now offering

R : the United States which
denied even helicopter nuts
and screws

S : and even Patriot missiles

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RQSP (b) QRPS
(c) QRSP (d) RQPS

- 28.** Drug abuse

P : dies down soon after

Q : that follows every expose

R : but the hue and cry

S : is an increasing vice among
party-hopping elites

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QPSR (b) QRSP
(c) SRQP (d) SPQR

- 29.** P : and in escaping such
misfortunes

Q : of our friends may be
invaluable

R : but many misfortunes which
threaten us are not inevitable

S : the advice and active
assistance

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RQSP (b) SPRQ
(c) RPSQ (d) SQRQ

- 30.** P : you are not to destroy or
dictate to millions

Q : born a king's son

R : or settle your differences
amicably with them

S : you can only expect to share
their fate

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRQP (b) QPSR
(c) SPQR (d) QRSP

- 31.** P : they have thought that it
would be a very good thing

Q : whether they worked hard or
lived quite idly

R : if everybody had exactly the
same amount of money

S : one common mistake that
many people have made is this

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SPRQ (b) QSRP
(c) SPQR (d) QSPR

32. We met

P : this evening

Q : on our way home

R : Mr and Mrs Gupta

S : and asked them if they would be free

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRPS (b) PQRS
-
- (c) RQSP (d) RQPS

33. P : the man

Q : made a complaint

R : at the police station

S : whose cycle was stolen

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PRSQ
-
- (c) PSQR (d) RPQS

34. P : please equally

Q : share the prize money

R : that all are satisfied

S : among your friends to make sure

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRSP (b) PQSR
-
- (c) QPRS (d) QPSR

35. P : in the middle of

Q : he stopped

R : his speech

S : to take a glass of water

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QRSP (b) PRQS
-
- (c) QPRS (d) PQRS

36. P : she introduced me at the party

Q : I had met

R : to a man

S : the previous night

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RPQS (b) PRQS
-
- (c) SPRQ (d) PQRS

37. P : the nun who was the Principal

Q : called an assembly

R : of my grand daughter's school

S : to announce the result of a fund raising drive

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PRQS
-
- (c) PQSR (d) PSRQ

38. P : is addressed to Mr. Shah

Q : this letter which is written in Gujarati

R : who is

S : my father's best friend

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) QPRS
-
- (c) QRSP (d) RSPQ

39. P : were sent by mistake

Q : to my father

R : who was very much surprised

S : the clothes that I ordered

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SQPR (b) PQSR
-
- (c) PQRS (d) SPQR

40. P : in the house was kept

Q : where the key

R : nobody seemed to know

S : to the main door

The proper sequence should be

- (a) RQPS (b) QPRS
-
- (c) SQPR (d) RQSP

41. Self taught experts

P : expected to go

Q : through which

R : the escapers

S : prepared maps of the country

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) SQRP
-
- (c) SRQP (d) PRQS

42. The President

P : a brief vacation at Shimla

Q : is returning from

R : in order to attend a press conference

S : with his wife and children

The proper sequence should be

- (a) QSRP (b) QPRS
-
- (c) SQPR (d) RSQP

43. P : they forget

Q : between defeat and victory

R : that the conditions of welfare have so altered

S : that there is not much difference today

The proper sequence should be

- (a) SRPQ (b) PQSR
-
- (c) RSQP (d) PRSQ

44. P : of the fingers and thumbs

Q : fingerprints are

R : the marks made by

S : the ridges on the ends

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PQSR
-
- (c) QRSP (d) SPQR

45. P : the perfect

Q : is

R : an intuitive one

S : inspiration

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PQSR
-
- (c) PSQR (d) SQPR

46. P : poetry comes when

Q : the mind is still

R : the greatest motion of

S : and body is relaxed

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) PQSR
-
- (c) RPSQ (d) RPQS

47. P : clinical trials were designed to

Q : test the efficiency of

R : the first phase of

S : the method

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) RSQP
-
- (c) RPQS (d) SPQR

48. P : to perform

Q : brains are engineered

R : complicated tasks

S : simple as well as

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) SRQP
-
- (c) QPRS (d) PQSR

49. P : companies reduce

Q : competition

R : by acquiring smaller or

S : rival companies

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQRS (b) SRQP
-
- (c) QPRS (d) QPSR

50. P : and ten kilometres away

Q : from Santorin lies

R : the Crete

S : one hundred

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQSR (b) SPQR
-
- (c) SPRQ (d) QSPR

51. P : minoan world

Q : the artifacts unearthed

R : so far

S : do give us precious insights into

The proper sequence should be

- (a) PQSR (b) SPQR
-
- (c) QRSP (d) QSPR